Aircraft noise at TW9 3PZ, Kew SAMPLE REPORT

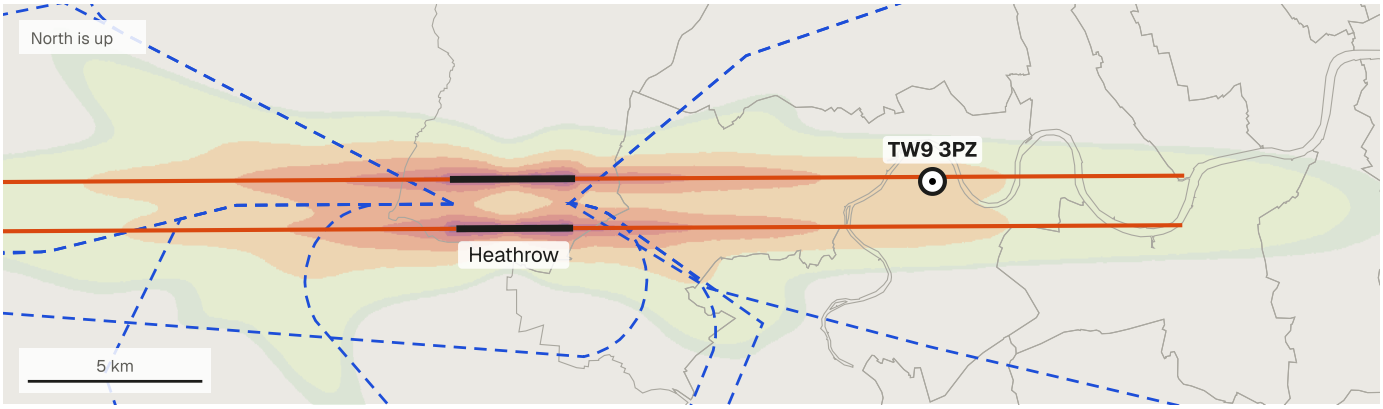
What the official noise map and the published flight routes say about this postcode, in Richmond upon Thames.

57 dB
average aircraft noise outdoors across a year (Lden), on DEFRA's official map. The WHO guideline is 45 dB

3.2/10
Sky Score's Quiet Skies score for this postcode. 10 is quietest

10.2 km
to the nearest runway, at Heathrow Airport, which lies to the west

0.1 km
from the approach line to Heathrow runway 27R, where landing aircraft are at about 1,800 ft



Published routes within 5 km

Route	Used when aircraft are	Closest point to this postcode	Height
Landings, Heathrow runway 27R	landing towards the west	0.1 km to the north	about 1,800 ft
Landings, Heathrow runway 27L	landing towards the west	1.3 km to the south	about 1,800 ft
Departures, Detling route, Heathrow runway 09	taking off towards the east	4.6 km to the south	not published

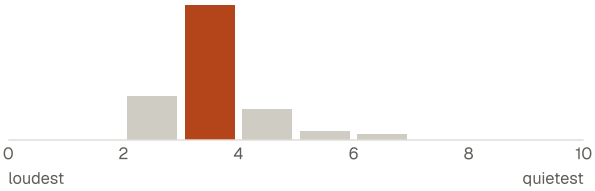
Airports covered: Heathrow and London City. Gatwick's routes are not included. Smaller airfields, military flights and helicopters are not covered.

What this shows

- Aircraft noise here averages **57 dB** outdoors across the year, 12 dB above the 45 dB the WHO recommends.
- Aircraft landing on Heathrow's runway 27R pass **0.1 km to the north** at about 1,800 ft, on days when the airport is landing towards the west.
- The nearest published departure route (Detling, runway 09) passes 4.6 km to the south.
- Of the 597 postcodes in TW9 on DEFRA's map, **61% are quieter** than this one and 29% are louder.

How it compares within TW9

Quiet Skies scores of the 597 postcodes on DEFRA's map. This postcode's band is in orange.



Also at this postcode: road noise 50.5 dB Lden (WHO guideline 53); nitrogen dioxide 17.0 µg/m³ (guideline 10); fine particles 8.6 µg/m³ (guideline 5); nearest station Kew Gardens, 20 m in a straight line.

Air measured nearby. Nearest Breathe London sensor: George Street, 2.2 km away (roadside, 0.7 m from the kerb): nitrogen dioxide 18.7 µg/m³ and fine particles 7.5 µg/m³ over the 12 months to September 2026. Breathe London sensors are low-cost: their figures are provisional and are recalibrated over time. A sensor by a road can read higher than DEFRA's background figure: it measures the traffic beside it, where DEFRA's is the average across a 1 km square. Each figure rests on at least 75% of the hours in its period.

Have your say. Heathrow's expansion consultation, open until 22 December · contact Heathrow about noise · find a flight on WebTrak. Flight paths change through the CAA's airspace change process: the CAA's airspace change portal shows each proposal and the stage it has reached.

Spotted something wrong? Tell us: local knowledge is the best check on data like this.

Reading this report. Lden is a yearly average of the outdoor level, with evening and night flights weighted more heavily; it does not describe single loud events or the number of flights. DEFRA's map models 2021, when COVID restrictions cut air traffic. At Heathrow the CAA's model of 2025 puts the 55 dB area at 142.4 km² against 75.6 km² on DEFRA's map, so levels today are likely to be higher than DEFRA's map shows. That is an indication, not a correction. The route lines are the published centre lines: aircraft fly either side of them, and the path to joining a final approach is directed by air traffic control and is not drawn. This is information, not a survey or an environmental search; visit at different times of day before deciding.

Sources: DEFRA Strategic Noise Mapping Round 4 (aircraft and road, Lden, 2021 traffic) and DEFRA background pollution maps, Open Government Licence v3.0; flight routes from the UK Aeronautical Information Publication (NATS), AIRAC 2026-10-29; CAA ERCD Report 2601 (August 2026); WHO Environmental Noise Guidelines for the European Region (2018) and Global Air Quality Guidelines (2021); postcode positions from postcodes.io (ONS). Contains Breathe London data licensed under the Open Government License v3.0. Compiled with Sky Score (skyscore.co.uk). Prepared 3 November 2026.